

Division of Community Nutrition

<i>Subject:</i> Breastfeeding Education		<i>Policy:</i> BF 02.0
<i>Reference:</i> §C.F.R. 246.11	<i>Effective:</i> January 6, 2025	<i>Supersedes:</i> March 14, 2022

I. Policy:

Local agencies must provide breastfeeding education to pregnant and breastfeeding participants.

II. Procedure(s):

- A. Breastfeeding education must be participant-centered and in alignment with the goals and objectives of the Virginia WIC Annual State and Local Agency Nutrition Education and Breastfeeding Plans.
- B. Nutrition staff must inform all pregnant participants of the following WIC benefits for breastfeeding participants:
 - 1) Longer participation in the program- breastfeeding participants are certified for one year and non-breastfeeding participants are only certified for 6 months.
 - 2) A greater quantity and variety of foods, with fully breastfeeding participants (those who do not receive any formula from WIC) ~~receive~~ receiving the greatest quantity and variety of foods.
 - 3) Individualized anticipatory guidance and education to support each participant in achieving their personal breastfeeding goals.
 - 4) Access to staff with specialized breastfeeding training.
 - 5) Breastfeeding supplies and aids, such as breast pumps.
- C. Nutrition staff or Breastfeeding Peer Counselors will educate each pregnant WIC participant on breastmilk hand expression utilizing:
 - 1) WIC Breastfeeding Curriculum Level 2.
 - 2) A breast model.
- D. WIC staff will offer:
 - 1) Each pregnant participant with a BAPT (Breastfeeding Attrition Prediction Tool) survey at certification.
 - 2) BAPT survey results review and scoring.
 - 3) Targeted counseling based on the BAPT screening.
 - 4) Educational material highlighting sections that address the participant's social support, breastfeeding knowledge, and confidence level.
 - 5) Participants with a prenatal breastfeeding class within 3 months of certification.
 - 6) Participants with a baby behavior class in the 3rd trimester.